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ence-driven solutions for sustainable development. Organized by the National Academy of Science and Technology, Philippines in partnership with the Department of Science and Technology (DOST) Luzon Cluster, led by Department of

 **(TURN TO PAGE 3)**

DOST SOCCSKSARGEN EXPANDS STI REACH THROUGH MOA... FROM PAGE 1



project, “Transforming STEM Education in Public Schools of Kidapawan through AI-Driven Robotics and Digital Fabrication,” was signed with DepEd Region XII Schools Division Office of Kidapawan City. Another initiative, “Transforming Science Beyond the Classroom Through PSC Exhibit-Based Lessons and Lab in a Box,” was implemented in collaboration with the Philippine Foundation for Science and Technology and the University of Southern Mindanao. These initiatives aim

to enhance teacher capabilities and provide learners with interactive, technology-enabled learning experiences. DOST also partnered with the Rotary Club of Mt. Apo as implementing partner and disbursing entity for seven community-based projects benefiting underserved sectors. These include initiatives supporting coffee enterprise development for smallholder farmers, livelihood and reintegration programs for persons deprived of liberty (PDLs), cultural preservation and women’s livelihood for the

Obo Manuvu community, restoration of a madrasa with ICT resources, and the establishment of digital hubs for youth in selected barangays. Collectively, these projects aim to promote inclusive growth, sustainability, and social reintegration. Under the Small Enterprise Technology Upgrading Program (SETUP), MOAs were signed to support local enterprises in improving productivity and competitiveness. One project focuses on deploying robust ICT systems to enhance online tutorial delivery,

while another introduces energy-efficient technologies in natural rubber manufacturing, including the integration of solar photovoltaic systems. These interventions are designed to boost operational efficiency and promote sustainable industrial practices. Meanwhile, under the Innovations for Filipinos Working Distantly from the Philippines (IFWDPH) Program, two beneficiaries formalized their participation through projects on fabric care innovation and safe water provision.

These initiatives highlight DOST’s commitment to supporting returning and transitioning overseas Filipino workers through sustainable, innovation-driven livelihood opportunities. The event was further enriched by messages of support from former DOST Secretary Fortunato T. de la Peña and University of Southern Mindanao President Dr. Jonald L. Pimentel. Also present were key stakeholders, including Rotary Club of Mt. Apo President Atty. Jonah Mineses and Schools Division Superintendent

Miguel Fillalan Jr., along with representatives from partner institutions who joined virtually. Through these partnerships, DOST SOCCSKSARGEN reaffirms its commitment to making STI accessible and impactful across communities, schools, industries, and marginalized sectors. The MOA signing symbolizes a shared dedication to implementing meaningful initiatives that will foster resilience, empowerment, and long-term development in Cotabato Province.

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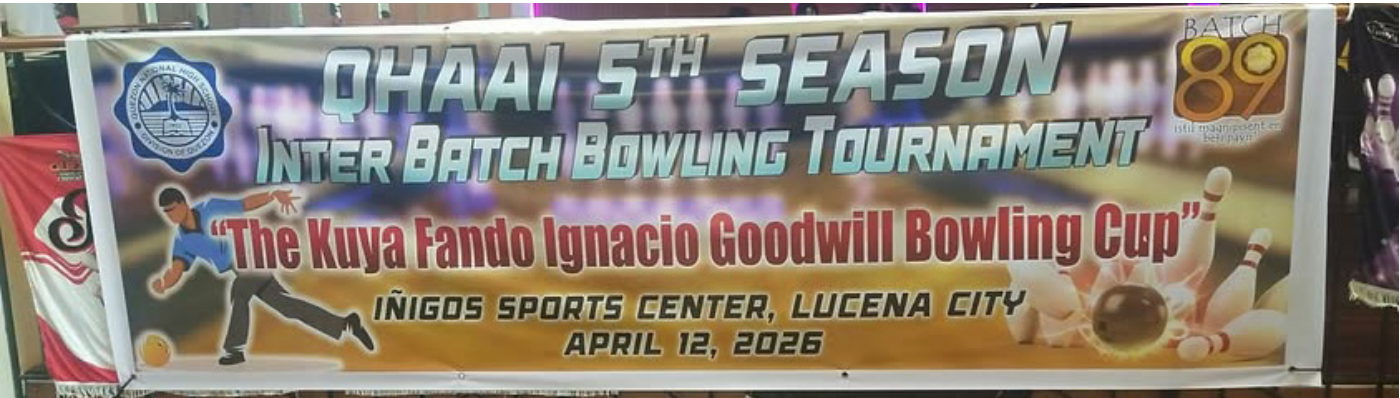
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QHAAI 5TH SEASON INTER-BATCH BOWLING TOURNAMENT, MAS PINA-LEVEL - UP NA SA IÑIGOS SPORTS CENTER



Mas pina-Level - Up na labanan, at tunggalian ngayon ng mga Batch Team Player, sa larangan ng pagalingan, at diskarte sa pagbato ng Bowling Ball ngayong ika-5th Season ng QHAAI Inter-Batch Bowling Tournament, sa Iñigos Sports Center, sa Barangay Domoit, sa lungsod ng Lucena. Ayon kay Mr. Jonathan Revelar, ang Presidente ng Batch 89, at Chairman of Sports Coordinator ng QHAAI Inter-Batch Bowling Tournament, may Dalawamput-Apat na

Team Player ngayon ang sumali, bilang kalahok nang bawat Class Batch ng Quezon National High School. Ang mga Batch Team Player ay nagmula sa Batch 1974, Batch -76, Batch -78, Batch -80, Batch -81-ab, Batch -82-abc, Batch -83-ab, Batch -84, Batch -85, Batch -86, Batch -87, Batch -88, Batch -89-abc, Batch -90, Batch -91, Batch -93, Batch -94, at ang Batch -95 na silang patuloy na tumatangkilik sa layunin ng QHAAI, na habang lumalaro ng Bowling, ay higit na nakakatulong

pa rin sa kanilang mga kaklase, at batchmate na may karamdaman. Kaya naman ang tunggalian ng bawat Batch Team Player, sa Bowling Tournament na ito, ay tatagal nang halos limang buwan, para din maisagawa ang labanan ng mga Single for Men & Women, maging ang Double for Men & Women, at ang Special Event, na puedeng gawin sa araw ng kanilang Rest Day, yung makakakuha ng Spare na tira ng 7 & 10, sa tuwing Elimination Round lang ito, ay magkakamit ng premyo

sa kada Event na ito. Dagdag pa ni Mr.Revelar, mas pinaganda nila ngayon ang Bowling Tournament na ito, sa pamamagitan pa rin, ng idinagdag niyang magkaruon ang bawat Batch Team Player ng Bowlers of the Week, para sa linggong labanan, at Bowlers of the Month, para buwanang magiging labanan ng bawat manlalaro sa ika-5th QHAAI Inter-Batch Bowling Tournament sa Iñigos Sports Center, sa Barangay Domoit, sa lungsod ng Lucena.

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**DOST ILOCOS REGION
BACKS P6.4M TECH
UPGRADES... FROM PAGE 1**



Mushroom Farm in Pan-gasinan received a combined ₱1,549,800.00, further expanding support for MSMEs across the region. Ms. Racquel M. Espiritu, Supervising Assistant Regional Director for SET-UP, emphasized that the initiative supports long-term enterprise growth beyond financial aid. “This program is about giving our MSMEs the chance to sprout, grow, and flourish – bringing jobs, products, and services that uplift families and communities across the nation,” she stated. Furthermore, Ms. Mary Ann B. Ofiana, Project Technical Assistant I, led the Gender Sensitivity Training, where she emphasized integrating gender perspectives and promoting equal opportunities in the workplace. This was followed by Ms. Katrina F. Ronquillo, SETUP RPMO Head, who outlined the beneficiaries’ duties as stipulated in the Memorandum of Agreement, discussed required reports, and answered participants’ questions.

Regional Director Tere-sita A. Tabao congratulated the beneficiaries and emphasized the role of MSMEs in economic growth and inclusive development. “I hope that you will not be content with just receiving that fund and improving your current processes but do better in coming up with more creative things and more innovative things. And while you do those, you will be mirroring some of the best practices that other MSMEs can learn from,” she said. The event concluded with closing remarks from Ms. Katrina F. Ronquillo, who thanked the Batch SIBOL beneficiaries for their trust and collaboration. “Your trust inspires us to do more, to serve better, and to continue bringing programs that truly make a difference,” she remarked. The ceremony highlighted the DOST Ilocos Region’s commitment to empowering MSMEs to grow, innovate, and achieve sustainable success, bringing ‘Agham na Ramdam’ closer to communities across the region.

**Luzon Scientists,
Leaders Convene...
From page 1**



Science and Technol-ogy – National Capital Region, the two-day event is anchored on the theme “UN SDGs: Science, Technology, and Innovation for Sustainable Development.” Key national figures graced the opening, including Renato U. Solidum Jr., Sancho A. Maborang, Napoleon K. Juanillo Jr., Jaime C. Montoya, and Michael O. Sinocruz. Their participation underscored the importance of collaborative, science-based policy-making in addressing the country’s most pressing development challenges. Day 1 sessions centered on assessing Luzon’s current progress toward achieving the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), with focused discussions on passive cooling strategies and pathways toward a net-zero emissions future. Experts highlighted the critical role of innovation in enhancing climate resilience, improving energy efficiency, and promoting sustainable urban development. The meeting, which

serves as the first leg of the 2026 Regional Scientific Meetings series, continues on April 8 with two additional plenary sessions tackling emerging priorities: the development of a bio-plastics industry roadmap alongside urban waste management solutions, and the application of artificial intelligence (AI)-based prediction systems to address climate-related disasters. Outcomes from the discussions are expected to be consolidated into policy recommendations and endorsed to relevant government agencies, contributing to evidence-based decision-making and strengthening science, technology, and innovation (STI) initiatives across Luzon. The Luzon RSM is part of an annual effort by NAST PHL to convene the country’s scientific community and key stakeholders in shaping responsive, forward-looking strategies that align with national and global development goals.

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SHOWBLITZ
By: Charlene Mae
**Di gumastos ng isang
buwan sa Japan Jodi Sta.
Maria, nakatanggap ng
tip sa chopstick!**



Ang daming na-touch sa pelikulang Midnight Girls na kuwento tungkol sa mga hostess na Pinay sa Japan na nagkaroon ng advance screening the other night. Makikita kasi sa pelikula ang mga hirap na pinagdaraan nila para sa kanilang pamilya na binubuhay sa bansa. Hindi madaling magtrabaho sa abroad lalo na at ganun ang nature ng trabaho. At naranasan ito nina Jodi Sta. Maria, Sanya Lopez, Loisa Andalio and Jane Oineza na bumiyah sa Japan para personal na maramdaman ang pagiging hostess sa totong buhay para nga sa pelikulang ito. Nagtrabaho sila ng tatlong gabi sa isang omise na walang naka-kaalam kung anong ginagawa nila. Basta mga bago silang saltang babae sila. “Bukod dun sa kailangan naming aralin mag-salita ng Nihongo, meron din kaming ginawang immersion. So, we spent three nights sa isang Omise, kung saan kami nagtatrabaho. “Walang nakakaalam sa mga Japanese clients na pumunta dun kung sino kami o kung bakit kami nandun. Ang alam lang nila, mga bago kaming salta na babae. “So, kailangan naming mag-show up, kung saan kailangan naming pumila at pipili iyong hapon kung sino sa amin ang gusto niyang maka-table. “May part din dun na i-entertain mo talaga sila. Kaya lang ang thick lang talaga ng language barrier. Pero hindi naman kami pinabayaan ng mga ‘Mama’ namin dun. In-assist talaga nila kami. “And then, bukod dun kung ano iyong ipagagawa nila kung sinabi nilang kumanta ka, kakanta ka. Kung papasayawin ka nila, sumayaw ka. And then, there was one night also as part of our immersion. “Nagkaroonkaming parang mini-show na merong center stage dun wherein the four of us had to perform. “And then, doon namin na-experience na iyong mga chopsticks, sinisingit nila. Kasi iyon ‘yung

parang tip. Tapos, dahil doon sa immersion namin, nagpapasalamat din ako doon dahil one month akong hindi gumastos para may pang-bili ako ng mga kape. So, kumita din ako sa Japan,” nangitingit pahayag ni Jodi sa karanasan sa paggawa ng Midnight Girls sa mga dumalong press nung isang gabi sa ginanap na media conference/preview ng pelikula. Pero aniya hindi lang basta tungkol sa mga babaeng nagtatrabaho sa Japan nakatuon ito kundi sa mga sakripisyo ng mga kababayan nating nasa ibang bansa na ginagawa ang lahat upang guminhawa ang naiwang pamilya sa Pilipinas. Kaya nga raw nang unang i-offer sa kanya ang pelikula, nakita niya raw kaagad na kakaiba ito sa mga naunang ginawa niya. “When it was first pitched to me. Actually, pitch pa lang, sabi ko kakaiba. It’s something that I’ve never done before. And it’s about time to really just bring out, out there iyong stories ng mga babae sa Japan. “At hindi lamang iyon eh. Maaaring sila ‘yung naging subject ng pelikula. Pero kung titignan mo talaga sa mas malaking lente, tinataackle dito iyong sakripisyo, ‘yung sitwasyon ng mga OFWs natin sa iba’t ibang parte ng bansa. And we really had to treat this story with so much respect kasi istorya ito ng buhay ng bawat Pilipino na nasa labas ng bansa natin. And we also wanted to humanize. “Kasi sometimes meron mga stigma na kasama iyong istorya ng mga babae sa Japan. So we really wanted to humanize them. And makita na itong mga taong ito ay may mga tootong pangarap. Itong mga taong to ay nagsasakripisyo. Hindi lamang para sa sarili pero para sa mga mahal nila sa buhay,” dagdag niyang impormasyon kung saan bilang si Vicky na isang single mom ay nagkaroon ng relasyon sa may asawang Hapon. Dinirek ito ni Irene Villamor, produced by Edgar Mortiz.

SPORTS NEWS

Cool Smashers sampa sa finals



MANILA, Philippines — Pinatumba ng Creamline ang Farm Fresh, 25-23, 14-25, 25-23, 25-19, papasok sa 2026 Premier Volleyball League All-Filipino Conference Finals kahapon sa FilOil Centre sa San Juan City.

Tinapos ng Cool Smashers ang single round-robin semifinals sa 2-1 at inihulog ang Foxies sa 1-2 sa kauna-unahang semis stint nito sapul nang sumali sa liga noong 2023. Pumalo si Tots Carlos ng 15 points para sa tropa ni coach Sherwin Meneses at may tig-13 markers sina Jema Galanza at Pangs Panaga.

Nagkadena si Bernadeth Pons ng tri-

ple-double na 12 points, 17 digs at 17 receptions habang may 26 excellent sets si setter Jia De Guzman. Ito ang ika-15 finals appearance ng 10-time PVL champions at target ang pang-11 korona.

Lalaban ng Creamline ang Cignal sa best-of-three championship series na magsisimula sa Martes sa Smart Araneta Coliseum.

“Iyong mga players talagang nag-step up, talagang gusto nilang manalo today, kasi iyong Farm Fresh hindi naman basta-basta, veteran team din,” ani Meneses.

“Gusto ng players ng Creamline talaga na manalo at makabalik sa finals at makalaban ulit iyon Cignal,” dagdag nito. Tinalo na ng

Cool Smashers ang Super Spikers, 25-19, 25-20, 15-25, 26-28, 16-14, sa preliminaries noong Marso 21.

Ito ang ikalawang pagkakataon na magtutuos sa PVL Finals ang Cool Smashers at Super Spikers matapos noong 2024 Invitationals kung saan nila winalis ang mga bataan ni coach Shaq delos Santos, 3-0, sa kanilang title series.

Pinamunuan ni Trisha Tubu ang Foxies, lalaban ang PLDT High Speed Hitters sa best-of-three series para sa third place trophy, sa kanyang game-high 21 points kasunod ang 19 markers ni Molina.

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